VILLAGE FOR HER

A PRACTICAL GUIDE

10 Ways to Actually Help a New Mom

Concrete ways to make life lighter - without asking her to manage the help.

> *The kindest question is often not, 'What do you need?' but, 'Would one of these two things help?'*

BEFORE YOU OFFER

Make the help easier to receive.

Many people care. The hidden burden is that the person who needs support is often asked to identify the need, assign the task, explain the details, and follow up. A better offer carries some of that work.

LESS HELPFUL

"Let me know if you need anything."

MORE USEFUL

"I can bring dinner Tuesday or do a grocery pickup Thursday. Would either help?"

LESS HELPFUL

"When can I come see the baby?"

MORE USEFUL

"Would a short visit help, or would a doorstep drop-off feel better this week?"

LESS HELPFUL

"You should rest."

MORE USEFUL

"I can take care of the dishes and laundry while you rest. Is that okay?"

Always leave room for no. An offer is supportive when declining it does not create guilt, an explanation, or a new task.

WAYS 01 - 03

Start with daily life.

Choose one action you can fully own. Ask permission, confirm the key detail, and follow through without needing reminders.

1

Bring food with a clear plan

Offer two possible days. Ask about allergies or strong dislikes. Use disposable or clearly labeled containers, and make a doorstep drop-off an easy option.

2

Handle a complete household task

Laundry means gather, wash, dry, fold, and put somewhere agreed. Dishes means load, run, unload, and wipe the counter. Completion matters.

3

Take one errand off the list

Pick up groceries, return a package, refill a household essential, walk the dog, or manage a school run. Offer the specific task you can do.

Try: "I can do a grocery pickup tomorrow. Send a list by noon if that would help; no pressure if not."

WAYS 04 - 06

Protect her time and attention.

Care can mean fewer messages, fewer decisions, and less social performance. Let the household set the pace.

4

Coordinate other helpers

With permission, become the point person. Share the meal plan, answer routine questions, and route offers toward needs she has already named.

5

Make visits useful and optional

Ask before coming. Arrive on time. Keep the visit short unless invited to stay. Offer to do a task, and be ready to leave without taking it personally.

6

Check in without requiring a reply

A simple "thinking of you; no reply needed" keeps the connection open. If you offer a call, give a short window and an easy way to decline.

A changed plan is information, not rejection. Respond with flexibility and keep the relationship safe.

WAYS 07 - 10

Help can travel any distance.

You do not have to live nearby to reduce the load. Useful support is about ownership and attention, not proximity.

7

Support the whole household

Bring enough food for others, help with siblings, replenish essentials, or take a routine responsibility off a partner's list.

8

Send a practical delivery

Ask what would be used. Consider a grocery credit, prepared meal, household supply, or local service instead of guessing what the family needs.

9

Remember after the first few weeks

Set a reminder to check in later. Offer the same concrete help when the first wave of attention has passed.

10

Believe what she says helps

Respect her preferences, culture, privacy, household routines, and changing boundaries. Care should feel like support, not supervision.

A SIMPLE NEXT STEP

Choose one thing and offer it clearly.

Write the message now. Two options are enough. Make no easy. Then do the full task if she says yes.

WHAT I CAN GENUINELY OFFER

A meal, an errand, a household task, a check-in, coordination, or support from far away:

THE MESSAGE I WILL SEND

Name the action and timing. Include an easy way to say no:

WHEN SUPPORT NEEDS A PLAN

Meet The Village Kit

The Village Kit helps a woman and the people around her make care easier to ask for, organize, give, and receive - with planning pages, boundaries, schedules, and ready-to-send messages.

Learn more at thevillageforher.com/village-kit